

The Prior Authorization Defense Kit

How to eliminate retroactive commercial denials.

The Crisis: Prior auth requirements surged 34% in 2025–2026. Retroactive denials have become commercial payers' #1 margin tactic.

Rule 1: Procedure-Specific Verification

Active coverage != authorized procedure.

- **EDI 270/271 Check:** Verify code-level prior auth requirements 72 hours in advance.
- **Peer-to-Peer Timing:** Schedule physician peer-to-peers within 48 hours of notice.
- **Auth Number Matching:** Auth number must match Box 23 on CMS-1500 identically.

Rule 2: The Service Location Trap

Why place-of-service mismatches void approvals.

- **POS 11 vs POS 22:** Auth approved for ASC (24) will instantly deny if billed in HOPD (22).
- **Date Window Slippage:** Auths typically expire in 30–60 days. Rescheduled visits require extension.
- **Modifier Deviations:** Adding unapproved bilateral or assistant surgeon codes voids primary auth.

Rule 3: Fast-Track Overturn Protocol

Winning overturned prior auth denials on first appeal.

- **Clinical Notes Packet:** Attach exact clinical notes proving LCD/NCD necessity criteria.
- **Date-Stamped Intake Log:** Prove intake staff verified requirements prior to date of service.
- **Regulatory Escapes:** Cite state Prompt Pay & clean claim statutes for bad-faith delays.

Eliminate Prior Auth Write-Offs

Automate your intake verification and stop retroactive write-offs.

Free Assessment: Request a 50-claim pilot review at aetherahealthcare.com/free-assessment